

Qinrui Xiahou

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APPOINTMENT

Incoming postdoctoral fellow

Joint appointment: HKU Business School and HKU Centre for AI, Management and Organization (CAMO).

EDUCATION

The University of Hong Kong, HKU Business School | 2022-2026

PhD in Economics. Completed September 24, 2026.

Research interests: Environmental, development, and organizational economics, with a focus on using field experiments for causal inference.

Thesis Advisory Committee: Guojun He, Jin Li, and Yanhui Wu.

Thesis Examination Committee: Jing Cai (UMD), Uta Schönberg, Hui Li, and Bingjing Li.

Thesis chapters

1. The Demand, Supply, and Market Responses of Corporate ESG Actions: Evidence from a Nationwide Experiment in China.
2. Simple Contracts for Busy Firms: Evidence from a Supply Chain Experiment.
3. Errors, Efforts, and Earnings: Belief Calibration, AI Decision Support, and the Labor Supply of Taxi Drivers.

Yale University, School of the Environment | 2019-2021

Master of Environmental Science.

Focus: Climate Change Economics and Policy. Academic Advisor: Robert O. Mendelsohn.

Renmin University of China, School of Environment & Natural Resources | 2015-2019

Bachelor of Economics of Resources and Environment.

WORKING PAPERS

He, G., & **Xiahou, Q.** (2026). The Demand, Supply, and Market Responses of Corporate ESG Actions: Evidence from a Nationwide Experiment in China.

Submitted to the Journal of Finance. SSRN 5291594.

Kang, L., Li, S., **Xiahou, Q.**, & Zhang, P. (2024). Gone with the Aid: How Paired Assistance Program Affects High-Stakes College Choices.

Revise & Resubmit at the Journal of Urban Economics. SSRN 4977681.

Chen, H., He, G., & **Xiahou, Q.** (2026). Delegation, Monitoring, and Engagement: A Field Experiment in Supply Chain Governance.

Invited to Submit to the Special Issue of the Journal of Development Economics.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Errors, Efforts, and Earnings: AI-Driven Field Experiment in Suboptimal Labor Supply Decisions (with Guojun He and Cheng Zheng).

Climate Change, Migration and the Design of Intercity Transportation Networks (with Guojun He and Shuo Li).

The "Shadow Principal": Party Organization and the Dual-Agency Problem in Chinese Corporate Governance.

PRE-DOCTORAL PUBLICATIONS

Fraas, A., Lutter, R., Murphy, J., **Xiahou, Q.**, Potter, J., & Gosling, S. D. (2025). What Are the Effects of Early Childhood Exposure to Environmental Lead on Personality? *Journal of Benefit-Cost Analysis*, 1-15.

Dolphin, G., & **Xiahou, Q.** (2022). World carbon pricing database: sources and methods. *Scientific Data*, 9(1), 573.

Xiahou, Q., Springer, C. H., & Mendelsohn, R. (2022). The effect of foreign investment on Asian coal power plants. *Energy Economics*, 105, 105752.

Liu, J., Yin, M., **Xia-Hou, Q.**, Wang, K., & Zou, J. (2021). Comparison of sectoral low-carbon transition pathways in China under the nationally determined contribution and 2° C targets. *Renewable and Sustainable Energy Reviews*, 149, 111336.

Liu, J.-L., Wang, K., **Xiahou, Q. R.**, Liu, F.-M., Zou, J., & Kong, Y. (2019). China's long-term low carbon transition pathway under the urbanization process. *Advances in Climate Change Research*, 10(4), 240-249.

Liu, J., **Xiahou, Q.**, Wang, K., Zou, J., & Kong, Y. (2019). Medium and long-term low-carbon development pathway of China's industrial sector. *China Soft Science* (in Chinese), (11), 31-41.

Wang, K., & **Xiahou, Q.** (2017). Progress and Prospects of Global Climate Negotiations after the Paris Agreement. *Journal of Environmental Economics* (in Chinese), 2(4), 141-152.

RESEARCH GRANTS

- **2025-2027**. National Natural Science Foundation of China (NSFC), Young Student Basic Research Program for PhD Candidates. Sole PI; RMB 300,000.
- **2026-2027**. MIT J-PAL Project AI Evidence Full RCT Grant. Co-PI; USD 165,000.
- **2026**. Research Postgraduate Student Innovation Award. PI; HKD 50,000.
- **2024-2025**. Additional Funding from RGC for Supporting Research Needs of HKPFS Awardees. PI; HKD 19,454.

FELLOWSHIPS, SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

- Hong Kong PhD Fellowship (HKPFS), 2022-2026.
- HKU Presidential PhD Scholarship (HKU-PS), 2022-2026.
- FBE PhD Research Progress Award, 2024-2025; FBE PhD Entrance Scholarship, 2022.
- Best Paper Award, CAFM, 2025; Best Presentation Award, Forum for Young Scholars on China's Education Finance Research, 2025.
- Outstanding Graduate and GCL Scholarship (one of ten recipients university-wide), Renmin University of China.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

The Demand, Supply, and Market Responses of Corporate ESG Actions: Evidence from a Nationwide Experiment in China

- **2026:** SFA Annual Meeting, Palm Springs (scheduled); Future Scholars in Finance Forum, Tsinghua University; Asia Meeting-China of the Econometric Society, HKU.
- **2025:** NBER Chinese Economy Working Group Meeting, CUHK; Paris December Finance Meeting, Paris; CAFM, Seoul (Best Paper Award).
- Monash Environmental Economics Workshop, Monash University; Chinese Economy Workshop, HKU; HEC-HKUST Sustainable Finance Workshop, HKUST.
- EEA Congress, Bordeaux School of Economics; GRASFI, Paris Dauphine University; CES China Annual Conference, Sun Yat-sen University; CFRC, Tsinghua University.
- Asian Economic Development Conference, PKU; CCER Summer Institute, PKU; ICCDS, SJTU; CAERE, SUFE; IFABS, Oxford; Inaugural ASU-HKU Interdisciplinary Conference, HKU.

Gone with the Aid: How Paired Assistance Program Affects High-Stakes College Choices

- **2025:** Jinan-SMU Conference on Urban and Regional Economics, Jinan University; Sino-Japanese SPACE Workshop, Hitotsubashi University.
- Forum for Young Scholars on China's Education Finance Research, PKU (Best Presentation Award); CCER Summer Institute, Peking University; Summer Meeting in Urban Economics, PHBS.

Delegation, Monitoring, and Engagement: A Field Experiment in Supply Chain Governance

- **2026:** NBER Organizational Economics Working Group Meeting, Cambridge (scheduled); Conference in memory of Professor Elisabeth "Betty" Sadoulet, UC Berkeley & JDE (scheduled); IMO-ESF Workshop, IESE Business School (scheduled); CCER Summer Institute, PKU.
- **2025:** Organization Science Paper Development Workshop, PKU GSM.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Ad-hoc journal reviewer

Management Science; Journal of Environmental Economics and Management; Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization; China Economic Review; Scientific Reports.

MENTORING AND RESEARCH AFFILIATIONS

Mentor to 2024 YDC Youth Ambassadors, Home and Youth Affairs Bureau of Hong Kong SAR.

During master's studies at Yale (2019-2021): Student Research Fellow, Yale Hixon Center for Urban Ecology; Student Associate, Yale Climate Change and Health Initiative.

RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

Resources for the Future

Research Analyst | Washington, DC
June 2021 - August 2022

- Conducted an empirical analysis of the long-term effect of lead emissions using a novel lead density measure.
- Co-authored a working paper on the employment effect of the California Cap-and-Trade Program.
- Developed a comprehensive jurisdiction-sector-year level carbon pricing database using GitHub, R, and Python.
- Coded a structural model and implemented simulations of the US land use conversion and its carbon implications.

Yale School of the Environment

Research Assistant to Kenneth Gillingham | New Haven, CT
September 2019 - May 2021

- Scraped rooftop solar suitability data and estimated an instrumental variable model for the Solarize Campaign.
- Modeled the energy-saving effects of the Clean Energy for America Act for the US Senate Committee on Finance.

Yale Emergency Support Team

Data Analyst | New Haven, CT
April 2020 - May 2020

- Designed and developed an interactive COVID-19 curve model for the City of New Haven with three teammates.
- Recoded the curve model from Python to R and Excel for the New Haven Mayor's Office.

The Environmental Research Center, Duke Kunshan University

Research Assistant to Junjie Zhang (remote) | Jiangsu, China
August 2017 - June 2019

- Prepared a policy memo on rationales, actions, and obstacles of the US withdrawal from the Paris Agreement.
- Led the technical report evaluating the impact of the US reversing climate change policies.

Programme of Energy and Climate Economics, Renmin University of China

Research Assistant to Ke Wang and Ji Zou | Beijing, China
December 2015 - June 2019

- Co-authored three papers on China's long-term low-carbon transition using LEAP energy modeling.
- Drafted the Global Climate Governance Regime section in the textbook Economics of Climate Change Mitigation.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Yale Department of Economics | New Haven, CT

Teaching Fellow, Economics of Natural Resources | August - December 2020

- Taught 48 TA sections on microeconomic theory and environmental economics.
- Led weekly discussions on the global oil market, climate change modeling, and other environmental issues.

CERTIFICATIONS

CFA Certificate in Sustainable Investing (issued 2024).
MITx MicroMasters Program in Statistics and Data Science (2021-2023).